

Quick Start Guide

Be running real transactions in 30 minutes

ShopTrack v2.7 — shoptrack.org

This guide takes you from "I just signed up" to "my business is fully on ShopTrack" in five focused days. Each day takes 20–40 minutes. Skip nothing on Day 1, but Day 4 (Production) is optional unless you make products from raw ingredients.

Before you start

Grab these so you can move through Day 1 without stopping:

- Your business logo (any image file — square works best)
- Your bank or mobile-money details as you want them to appear on invoices
- A list of the 10–20 products or services you sell most often
- Your business WhatsApp number (the one customers already message you on)

Read this if nothing else

ShopTrack works offline. Internet drops? Keep recording sales, rentals, and appointments — everything syncs automatically when you reconnect. Bookmark the app on your home screen for one-tap access.

Day 1 — Set up your business identity

About 30 minutes. By the end of today, your account looks professional, prints proper invoices, and can process your first real sale.

Step 1 — Profile (5 min)

1. Settings → Business Profile. Fill in business name, your name, WhatsApp, address. Upload your logo.
2. Set your country, time zone, and currency. The currency choice affects every amount in the app — pick once, change rarely.
3. Save. The header now shows your logo wherever you go.

Step 2 — Money & invoices (10 min)

1. Settings → Documents. Set your default payment terms (Net 7 / Net 14 / Due on Receipt).
2. Add your bank and mobile-money details exactly as you want them on invoices. Customers will see this on every PDF you send.
3. Upload your signature and stamp PNGs if you have them. These appear on signed invoices and quotes.

Step 3 — Your first real sale (15 min)

Pick the next customer who walks in or messages you. Don't do a test sale — do a real one. The motion of doing it once removes 90% of the friction.

1. Sales → + New Sale → pick or create the customer (just their name and WhatsApp number is enough).

2. Add the item(s). If they're not in Inventory yet, create them on the spot from the sale.
3. Pick payment method, save. WhatsApp opens with the receipt pre-filled — tap Send. Your customer has their receipt in seconds.

Why this matters

Most owners stall at Day 1 because they try to enter all their historical data before doing anything real. Don't. Get the first live transaction in. The next ones cost almost no friction once the muscle memory is there.

Day 2 — Inventory, suppliers, customers

About 30 minutes. Today you build out the things you sell and the people you buy from. Skip products you sell rarely; just add your top 15–20.

Inventory (15 min)

1. Inventory → + Add Item for each product. Set: name, category, sale price, cost (so margin reports work), and current stock on hand.
2. Set a minimum stock threshold on each — ShopTrack alerts you when stock dips below it.
3. Add at least one photo per item. Photos show on your booking page, on receipts, and in customer-facing PDFs.
4. Optional but recommended: set the Preferred Vendor on each item — the supplier you usually buy it from.

Preferred Vendor = one-tap reorder

Setting a Preferred Vendor on an inventory item powers the  Reorder button — visible on every inventory row, on low-stock alerts, and inside the item detail. One tap opens a new Purchase pre-filled with the item, vendor, and last-known unit cost. Saves 30 seconds every time you restock.

Suppliers (10 min)

1. Vendors → + Add Vendor for each supplier you buy from. WhatsApp, contact name, payment terms.
2. Purchases → + New Purchase to log a recent supplier delivery. Link line items to inventory so stock increments automatically.
3. Mark the purchase Received (or Paid if you paid on delivery). Stock now reflects the real situation.



Reorder button

Found it on the inventory list yet? Every row has it. The dashboard's Low Stock alerts have it too. From "I see we're running low" to "Purchase order ready to confirm" is two clicks.

Customers (5 min)

1. You'll add customers as they buy — no need to import a list. Each sale creates a customer record if one doesn't exist yet (matched by phone number).
2. Settings → Customer Types lets you create custom labels: VIP, Wholesale, Walk-in, B2B. Use them to filter for marketing or follow-up.

Day 3 — Bookings & appointments (if you take bookings)

About 30 minutes. Skip this day if you don't take appointments. Otherwise, by the end of today you have an online booking page customers can use.

Services (10 min)

1. Services → + New Service for each service you offer. Name, duration, price, optional photo.
2. Two toggles per service: Active (available on invoices & quotes) and Visible on booking page (customers can book it online). Use them independently — a private consultation rate can be Active but not Bookable.
3. Set the price model: Flat rate, Hourly, Per unit. Mix them — most businesses use Flat for some services and Hourly for others.

Public booking page (10 min)

1. Settings → Booking Page → toggle "Accept online bookings" ON.
2. Customise the confirmation note customers see ("We confirm bookings within 6 hours during business hours.").
3. Use the  QR Code button to print a code for your counter, flyers, or business cards.
4. Tap  Preview Page to see exactly what customers will see.

Availability (10 min)

Appointments →  Availability Manager controls what the booking page lets people pick:

- Whole-day blocks for vacation, holidays, supplier-trip days.
- Partial-day blocks for lunch breaks, focus mornings, regular weekly commitments.
- Project execution windows — once a project is confirmed, block the install days so no one can double-book over them.



Appointment photos

Every appointment can hold up to 6 photos with captions. Use them for site-visit shots, reference styles, before/after work, or condition records. Photos flow automatically into the Project Pack PDF when you generate one for a client.



Add to Calendar

Every confirmed appointment has an Add to Calendar button. Tap it on your phone — a small .ics file downloads and your default calendar (Google, Apple, Outlook) opens with the event ready to add, including a 15-minute reminder. Useful for pushing client meetings to your personal phone

calendar.

Day 4 — Production module (skip if you don't make things)

About 30 minutes. ShopTrack's Production module is for businesses that turn raw ingredients into finished products in batches: bakeries, ice cream makers, restaurants pre-prepping sauces, soap makers, candle makers, custom paint mixers, breweries.

If you only buy and resell, you don't need this. Skip to Day 5.

Setting up a recipe (15 min)

1. In Inventory, make sure each raw ingredient exists as its own item with unit (g/ml/each), current stock, and unit cost.
2. Add the finished product as its own inventory item too (e.g. "Vanilla Ice Cream — 5L tub") with a sale price and qty 0.
3. Edit the finished product → expand the 🍹 Recipe panel → click "+ Add Ingredient" and list everything that goes into one batch. The "Cost per batch" pill updates live. Save.

Logging a production batch (5 min per batch)

1. Production page → "+ New Batch" → pick the product, set the multiplier (1× = one batch as the recipe defines).
2. Watch the live preview. Ingredients show with ✓ OK / SHORT BY N status. If anything is short, Save is disabled and the shortage is listed in red.
3. Save. ShopTrack atomically deducts the ingredients, increments the finished product, generates a batch ID, and records the true cost.

Concrete example

Vanilla ice cream recipe: 1500ml cream + 800ml milk + 200g sugar + 2 vanilla beans per 5L batch. Multiplier 1 deducts all four ingredients from stock and adds 1 × "Vanilla Ice Cream — 5L tub" with the exact batch cost as its cost basis. Future sales of that tub report honest margins.

Day 5 — Habits that make it work long-term

About 15 minutes today, then five minutes a day forever. The platform pays back what you put in — these are the routines that turn a tracking app into a business asset.

Daily

- Record every sale and rental as it happens. "I'll add it later" is the death of clean data.
- Receive supplier deliveries as Purchases the day they arrive. Snap the receipt.
- Check the Dashboard at end of day. 30 seconds tells you if today was healthy.

- Reply to WhatsApp booking requests within an hour. The platform notifies you — your job is the human reply.

Weekly

- Sunday evening: open Availability Manager for the week ahead. Block confirmed appointments, focus time, days off.
- Review Low Stock alerts. Reorder anything below threshold with the  button.
- Check AR Outstanding. Follow up on unpaid invoices with a WhatsApp reminder (one-tap from the customer page).

Monthly

- Reports → P&L for last month. Read the numbers. Note what surprised you.
- Review your top 10 customers. Are any of them quiet? A "we miss you" WhatsApp gets results.
- Settings → Backup. ShopTrack syncs to the cloud automatically, but a manual export every month is good hygiene.

When you get stuck

ShopTrack support is real humans, not bots.

- WhatsApp: +1 304 503 3113 — fastest response
- Email: support@shoptrack.work
- In-app: Settings → Documents has the full Owner Manual for reference

— End of Quick Start —